Grade 8 Home Language
Paper 2: Comprehension and Language

Name: _____ Date: _____

Time: 1 Hour Total: _____ / 50

Instructions

1. This paper consists of two sections:
   SECTION A: Reading for Meaning
   SECTION B: Language in Context
2. All questions are compulsory.
3. Start each **SECTION** on a new page.
4. Write neatly and legibly.

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Text A:

Why the Zika outbreak marks a new normal for infectious disease

- Bryan Walsh

1. It's commonly thought that mosquito-borne diseases – those that cause birth defects, illness or death – are something only poor or tropical countries need to fear. However, malaria wasn't eradicated from the blistering American South until World War II. The Centers for Disease Control and Prevention (CDC) grew out of that campaign.

2. Now there's a new contagious invader to fear: Zika. Zika was discovered in Uganda in 1947 and believed to cause mild flu-like symptoms. More recently, an infected traveller brought the virus to Latin America, and it spread like wildfire to more than 20 countries and infected hundreds of thousands of people. But the real concern is how the Zika virus seems to affect pregnant women. Brazil reported around 4 000 cases of microcephaly since the first case of Zika was detected in May 2015, compared to 150 cases in 2014. Microcephaly is a birth defect which causes a shrunken head and brain damage. Scientists have speculated that Zika infections in pregnancy may be the cause of microcephaly in infants. The CDC has warned pregnant women against travelling to affected Latin American countries.

3. Thus far few Zika cases have been recorded in the U.S., mostly in travellers who got infected elsewhere. This means Zika most likely isn't actively spreading in the U.S., but the World Health Organisation predicts the disease will reach every country in the Americas... except Canada and Chile, of course, since they're the only two countries in which the Aedes mosquito (that carries the virus) isn't found.

4. Like other infectious diseases that have wreaked havoc in the U.S. (e.g., malaria or Ebola), Zika reminds us how connected we all are today. There's barely a place on Earth more than 24 hours from a main city. In the globalised world we live in, we're only as strong as the weakest health link. Even if the U.S. can control the Zika within its borders, the out-of-control spread in remaining areas of the region will pose a constant threat, especially with the Summer Olympics coming up in Brazil. There are no walls that can keep out disease.

5. Zika diagnoses require confirmation by lab tests, but at least four out of five people never show symptoms, making the virus hard to track and stop. The surge of Zika cases and the virus's ability to cross the placental barier between mother and foetus suggests that it may have mutated, which worries scientists.

6. Humans may not like warmer climates, but disease-carrying mosquitoes do. They bite more and fly farther, and the viruses they carry seem to replicate faster. So while public-health officials prepare for the onslaught of insect-borne disease, a new reality is setting in: in a warmer, connected world, Zika isn't an epidemic. It's a part of life.



- Adapted from TIME Magazine, February 8, 2016

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Section A: Reading for Meaning

Question 1: Comprehension

Read the Text A section and answer the questions that follow.

1.1. Using your own words, explain what "insect-borne diseases" means (paragraph 1). (1)

1.2. Why do you think the writer says that these diseases "are something only poor, tropical countries need to fear"? (2)

1.3. Is CDC (paragraph 1) an abbreviation or an acronym? Give a reason for your answer. (2)

1.4. Write down the abbreviation for the World Health Organisation (paragraph 3)? (1)

1.5. Refer to paragraph 2. Describe how the Zika virus has changed over the years, in how it affects people. (2)

1.6. What preventive measure has the CDC taken to avoid the risk of rising cases of Microcephaly? (1)

1.7. Refer to paragraph 3. What does the World Health Organisation expect the Zika virus to do? (1)

1.8. Explain why Chile and Canada are not expected to report any Zika cases in the future? (1)

1.9. List two reasons that indicate that the Zika virus is not actively spreading in the U.S. (2)

1.10. On which other continent could you contract Malaria and Ebola? (1)

1.11. Mention two points that show how the Zika virus has possibly mutated. (2)

1.12. Describe what makes the Zika virus hard to detect and contain? (1)

1.13. In your own words, explain what is meant by a "globalised world". (1)

1.14. Considering what South Africa has experienced with Covid-19, what steps do you think the U.S. should take to prevent further spread of the Zika virus. (2)

TOTAL : 20

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Question 2: Advertisement Analysis

Read the text below and answer the questions that follow.

Text B:



2.1. What product is being advertised? (1)

2.2. Name the brand of the product. (1)

2.3. What statistical claim has the advertiser made? (1)

2.4. Name two other advertising techniques used in this advertisement. (2)

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2.5. Who is the target audience for this advertisement? (1)

2.6. Why do you think the advertiser has chosen to include the words "lemon fragrance" in the copy? (2)

2.7. What is the 2 in 1 benefit the product advertises? (2)

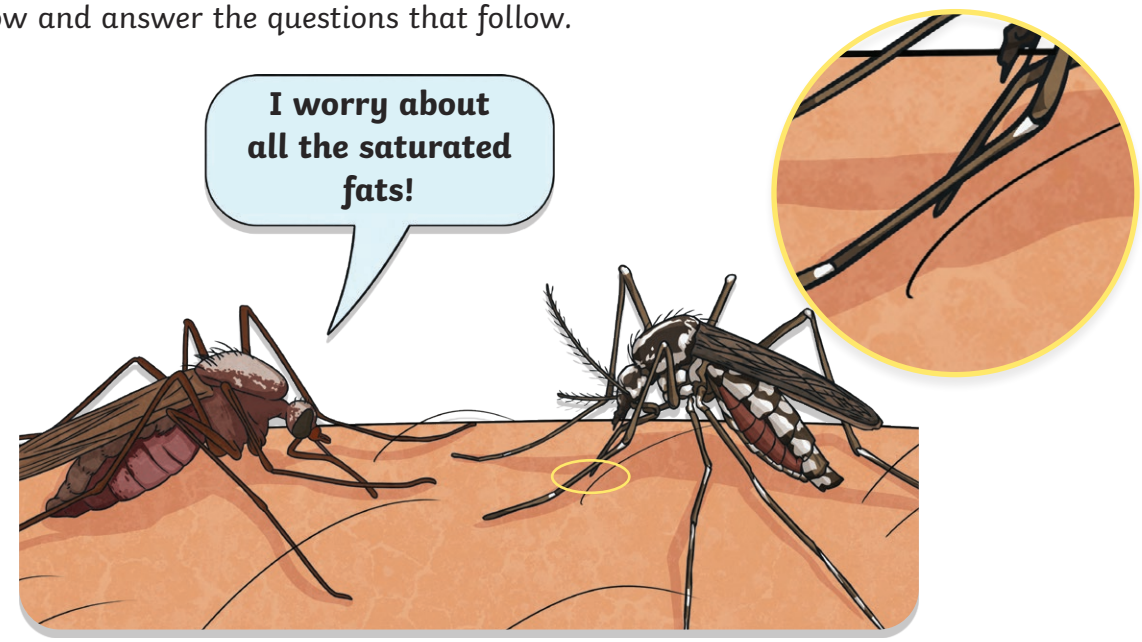
TOTAL : 10

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Question 3: Cartoon Analysis

Read the text below and answer the questions that follow.

Text C:



3.1. What issue is being addressed in the cartoon? (1)

3.2. Describe how the cartoonist has illustrated that the mosquitoes are biting the human? (2)

3.3. Explain why the caption is ironic. (2)

3.4. How has the cartoonist depicted the mosquito's concern? (1)

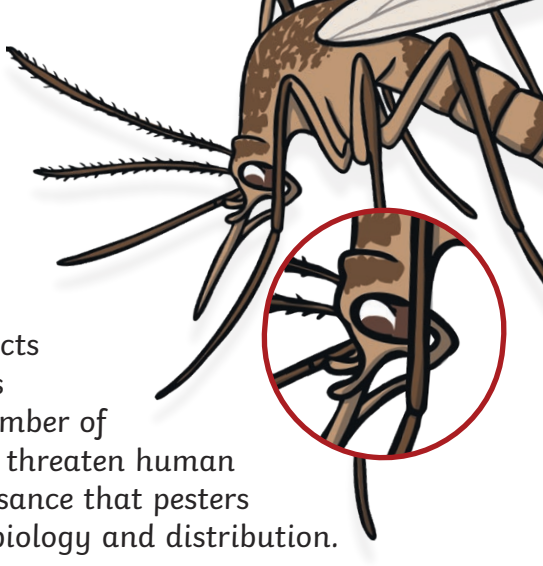
3.5. Do you think the mosquito's concern about saturated fats is worth worrying about? Motivate your answer. (2)

TOTAL : 8

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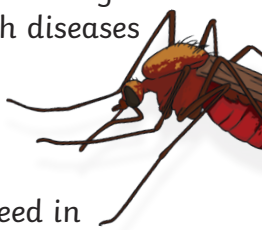
Text D:

Not all mosquitoes are created equal



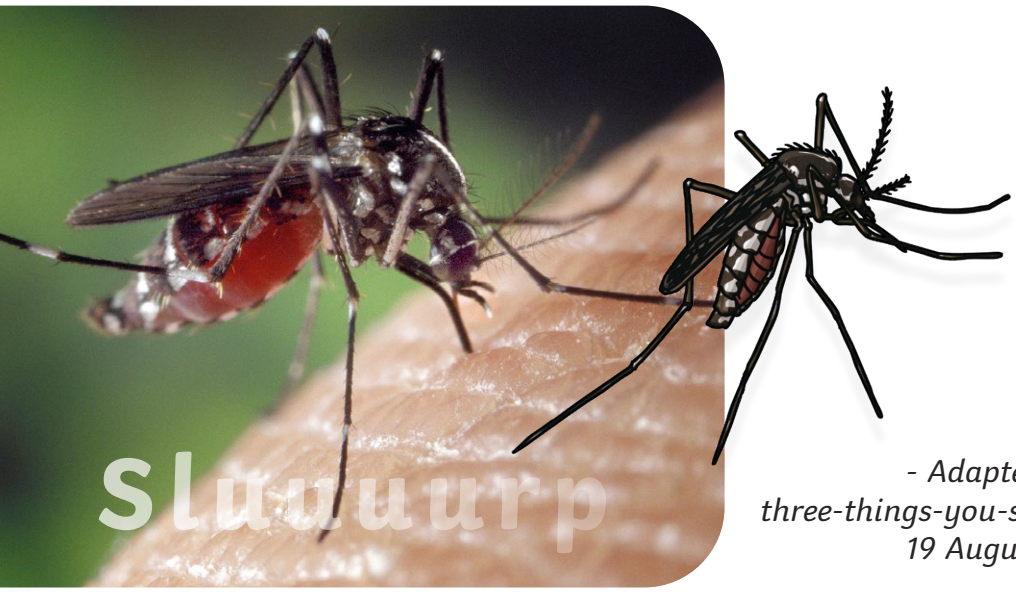
1. Mosquitoes are widely considered among the deadliest insects on the planet. Malaria is associated with half of the deaths credited to these creatures. But mosquitoes also carry a number of other parasites, viruses and nematodes (roundworms) that threaten human health. Mosquitoes are generally regarded as the noisy nuisance that pesters you at night. But there are significant differences in their biology and distribution. There are around 3,500 mosquito species across five genera.

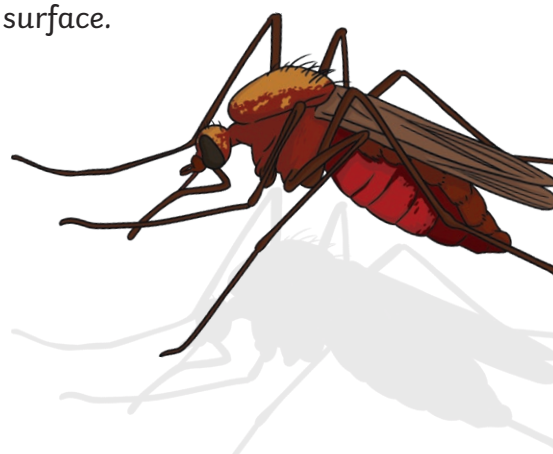
2. The whiny mosquito that immediately comes to mind is most probably part of the Culex genus, which is active at nite. These mosquitoes lay their eggs as egg rafts in a variety of diferent water bodies (breeding sites). In some areas they are associated with diseases like West Nile virus and Japanese encephalitis, but not in South Africa.



3. Comparatively, Aedes mosquitoes are usually encountered during the day. These mosquitoes are black, characterised by white or silvery markings and breed in containers like tyres or tree holes. Instead of laying their eggs directly onto the water, they lay single eggs on the damp sides of a water body. These mosquitoes also transmit various deadly viruses including dengue, yellow fever and Zika.

4. Unlike Aedes and Culex mosquitoes, Anopheles mosquitoes make only a soft buzzing sound and hence are often referred to as “silent killers”. Around 70 of the approximately 460 Anopheles species have been associated with malaria transmission. Adult Anopheles mosquitoes are brown or black with spotted wings and are usually active between dusk and dawn. They also have a very distinct resting posture. Their abdomens point away from the surface they are resting on at a 45 degree angle, as opposed to resting parallel to the surface. Female anopheline mosquitoes also lay single eggs on the surface of water bodies and hatched larvae lie parallel to the water surface.





- Adapted from https://www.nicd.ac.za/three-things-you-should-know-about-mosquitoes/, 19 August 2021 [Accessed 23 June 2022]

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Question 4: Language in Context

Read the text below and answer the questions that follow.

4.1. Explain the use of brackets in paragraph 1. (1)

4.2. Write down a synonym for 'pesters' in paragraph 2. (1)

4.3. Correct the spelling errors in paragraph 3. (2)

4.4. QUOTE an example of alliteration from the passage. (1)

4.5. Rewrite the following sentence and underline the phrase: (2)

Female anopheline mosquitoes also lay eggs on the surface of water bodies and hatched larvae lie parallel to the surface of the water.

4.6. Rewrite the following sentence using the passive voice: (2)

These mosquitoes transmit deadly viruses.

4.7. Change the following words to the part of speech indicated in brackets: (2)

active (adverb) _____

whiny (verb) _____

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4.8 Write down the part of speech of the underlined words in the passage. (2)

_____

_____

_____

TOTAL : 12

GRAND TOTAL : 50

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Grade 8 Home Language Paper 2: Comprehension and Language - **Answers**

Instructions

1. This paper consists of two sections:
   SECTION A: Reading for Meaning
   SECTION B: Language in Context
2. All questions are compulsory.
3. Start each SECTION on a new page.
4. Write neatly and legibly.

Section A: Reading for Meaning

Question 1: Comprehension

Read the Text A section and answer the questions that follow.

1.1. Using your own words, explain what "insect-borne diseases" means (paragraph 1). (1)

A disease or illness that is carried by mosquitoes. OR A disease or illness that you get from a mosquito bite.

1.2. Why do you think the writer says that these diseases "are something only poor, tropical countries need to fear"? (2)

Poorer countries have more poor people who live in poverty with less access to good hygiene and little/no access to good public health care.

1.3. Is CDC (paragraph 1) an abbreviation or an acronym? Give a reason for your answer. (2)

Abbreviation; it is the combination of the first letter of each word (Centers for Disease Control) – it does not form a new word.

1.4. Write down the abbreviation for the World Health Organisation (paragraph 3)? (1)

WHO.

1.5. Refer to paragraph 2. Describe how the Zika virus has changed over the years, in how it affects people. (2)

At first it caused only flu-like symptoms, now it seems to be causing microcephaly in infants whose mothers were infected during pregnancy. (Accept similar alternative)

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1.6. What preventive measure has the CDC taken to avoid the risk of rising cases of Microcephaly? (1)

They have warned women not to travel to affected countries in Latin America.

1.7. Refer to paragraph 3. What does the World Health Organisation expect the Zika virus to do?(1)

The WHO expects the Zika virus to spread to every country in the Americas.

1.8. Explain why Chile and Canada are not expected to report any Zika cases in the future? (1)

They are the only two countries in which the Aedes mosquito (that carries the Zika virus) is not found.

1.9. List two reasons that indicate that the Zika virus is not actively spreading in the U.S. (2)

Few cases have been recorded; the cases recorded have been in travellers who were infected/got sick elsewhere and brought the virus home.

1.10. On which other continent could you contract Malaria and Ebola? (1)

Africa

1.11. Mention two points that show how the Zika virus has possibly mutated. (2)

The rise in the number of cases; and the virus is seemingly able to penetrate through the protective barrier of the placenta, affecting foetuses.

1.12. Describe what makes the Zika virus hard to detect and contain? (1)

A Zika diagnosis must be confirmed by lab tests; four out of five infected people do not show symptoms. (Any one)

1.13. In your own words, explain what is meant by a "globalised world". (1)

Improvements in communication technology have decreased the effects of time and space – people are able to communicate instantly, regardless of how far apart they live from each other.

1.14. Considering what South Africa has experienced with Covid-19, what steps do you think the U.S. should take to prevent further spread of the Zika virus. (2)

Accept learner's own, logical response. Answers should typically include mention of a travel ban and the development of a Zika vaccine.

TOTAL : 20

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Question 2: Advertisement Analysis

2.1. What product is being advertised? (1)

Mosquito repellent spray (accept insect repellent)

2.2. Name the brand of the product. (1)

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2.3. What statistical claim has the advertiser made? (1)

"100% kill guarantee".

2.4. Name two other advertising techniques used in this advertisement. (2)

Bold heading;
picture

2.5. Who is the target audience for this advertisement? (1)

People who own/rent their own homes; OR people who are going camping/on holiday to a high-risk area.

2.6. Why do you think the advertiser has chosen to include the words "lemon fragrance" in the copy? (2)

To let readers/buyers know that the product is safe to use because it does not smell like chemicals, like many other insect repellents do.

2.7. What is the 2 in 1 benefit the product advertises? (2)

Kills unwanted insects like mosquitoes and stops others from coming.

TOTAL : 10

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Question 3: Cartoon Analysis

3.1. What issue is being addressed in the cartoon? (1)

The cartoon addresses the universal issue of how poorly humans eat these days/how un healthy humans have become.

3.2. Describe how the cartoonist has illustrated that the mosquitoes are biting the human. (2)

Their mouths are pointed straight into the skin, and the area around the tip of their mouths is raised, which indicates swelling of the skin.

3.3. Explain why the caption is ironic. (2)

Usually humans are concerned about the illnesses/diseases they could contract from mos quitoes/insects. Here the mosquitoes express concern for what they could contract from biting the human who has consumed saturated fats/follows an unhealthy diet.

3.4. How has the cartoonist depicted the mosquito's concern? (1)

The mosquito's facial expression: its eyes are wide, showing it is worried/concerned.

3.5. Do you think the mosquito's concern about saturated fats is worth worrying about? Motivate your answer. (2)

YES: because humans do not eat healthily – they consume fatty foods which could affect the mosquito; OR

NO: humans have more reason to fear what they could contract from mosquitoes; mosquitoes have a short life span.

TOTAL : 8

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Question 4: Language in Context

4.1. Explain the use of brackets in paragraph 1. (1)

Adds extra information.

4.2. Write down a synonym for 'pesters' in paragraph 2. (1)

Annoys/bothers/disturbs/irritates

4.3. Correct the spelling errors in paragraph 3. (2)

nite – night; diferent – different

4.4. QUOTE an example of alliteration from the passage. (1)

"noisy nuisance" (Accept "larvae lie" or "Adult Anopheles"; do not award a mark if it is not quoted)

4.5. Rewrite the following sentence and underline the phrase: (2)

Female anopheline mosquitoes also lay eggs on the surface of water bodies and hatched lar vae lie parallel to the surface of the water.

Female anopheline mosquitoes also lay eggs <u>on the surface of water bodies</u> and...

4.6. Rewrite the following sentence using the passive voice: (2)

These mosquitoes transmit deadly viruses.

Deadly viruses are transmitted by these mosquitoes.

4.7. Change the following words to the part of speech indicated in brackets: (2)

active (adverb) **actively**

whiny (verb) **whine**

4.8 Write down the part of speech of the underlined words in the passage. (2)

you – personal pronoun; are – auxiliary verb (do not award marks for 'pronoun' or 'verb' – learners must specify).

TOTAL : 12

GRAND TOTAL : 50